Preventing pressure injury takes more than a mattress

> *Protect comfort and dignity as well as skin. Ask for a practical plan caregivers can follow.*

How injury starts

Sustained pressure can damage skin and deeper tissue. Limited movement, moisture, poor nutrition and existing damage affect risk. Pain or a colour change matters even before the skin breaks.

What to check

Ask how to inspect heels, the lower back, hips and skin beneath devices. Persistent discolouration, warmth, pain, blistering or broken skin needs review. Redness can be less visible on darker skin.

Personalise movement and support

A trained team should assess risk and specify repositioning and pressure relief. The plan needs to account for comfort, mobility and the support surface. Learn safe handling rather than dragging fragile skin. A specialist mattress does not replace the rest of the plan.

Avoid well-meant harm

Do not massage or rub vulnerable skin to prevent pressure ulcers. Ask about moisture care and nutrition assessment. Do not automatically add high-protein supplements or extra fluid when kidney, heart or swallowing conditions require another plan.

Report deterioration

Seek review for persistent colour change, pain, a blister or a wound. Fever, spreading redness, pus or marked illness needs urgent assessment. Do not select antibiotics or wound creams from a general article.

> For a life-threatening emergency in India, call 112. Elsewhere use your local emergency number.

Questions you may have

Does intact skin mean all is well?

No. Early changes can appear before an open wound.

What to remember

A mattress supports prevention; it does not replace skin checks, movement and an individual care plan.

Sources and further reading

NICE CG179 — pressure-ulcer prevention and management
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg179/chapter/recommendations

NICE — preventing pressure ulcers
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg179/ifp/chapter/prevention

NIDDK — healthy eating with chronic kidney disease
https://www.niddk.nih.gov/health-information/kidney-disease/chronic-kidney-disease-ckd/healthy-eating-adults-chronic-kidney-disease

NHS — swallowing problems
https://www.nhs.uk/symptoms/swallowing-problems-dysphagia/

NHS — pressure ulcers and warning signs
https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/pressure-sores/

Government of India — Emergency Response Support System 112
https://112.gov.in/about

Educational information supports understanding and does not replace individual medical care. Follow your clinician's plan. Do not change medicines on your own. Sources checked: 24 October 2026.

Website: https://home-visiting-icu-doctor.vercel.app/#wikiSection
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